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"No other democracy has grown as sustainably as India"

Arvind Panagariya, Chairman of the 16th Finance Commission, says the crude oil situation is unlikely to get any worse

BY **SURABHI**

CONFIDENT ABOUT THE fundamentals of the Indian economy, Arvind Panagariya, Chairman, 16th Finance Commission and former Vice Chairman, NITI Aayog, remains optimistic about the outlook and hopes that the economy would be able to sail through the current crisis emanating from the war in West Asia.

Panagariya, who is now a professor at Columbia University also expects benefitting from the trade pacts with the UK and the EU. He also says that the lack of a trade deal with the US will not lead to any adverse impact on India's growth. Edited excerpts:

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The Indian economy has been performing well, with 7.8% growth in Q1FY27 despite the West Asia war. Do you think this can be sustained?

We have sustained this growth for quite a while despite several shocks. There were at least three to four shocks since 2003-04, including the global financial crisis shock. Then in 2011-12 and 2012-13, when we were amongst the 'Fragile Five' economies, followed by the NPA shock and the Covid-19 pandemic.

In spite of all this, India's GDP growth rate over this almost 20–21-year period was reasonably close to 7%. My calculations in real dollar terms